

RAISING THE MAGNETISM

NISSAN HAS DECIDED TO EXPAND THE MAGNITE'S REACH BY ADDING AN AMT GEARBOX TO THE ACCESSIBLE 1.0 NA ENGINE. WE PUT THE NEW VARIANT THROUGH ITS PACES

BY ANAGH BHASKAR



The Magnite has led a resurgence for the Japanese automaker in India and is single-handedly responsible for keeping the brand afloat. However, it had one chink in its armour—the lack of an automatic transmission for the 1.0-litre NA petrol engine. Nissan has now added an automatic option in the form of a 5-speed AMT to the naturally aspirated motor, and has named it the EZ-Shift.

The Magnite is quite impressive now in the looks department. It has sharp styling coupled with butch proportions and an impressive ground clearance of 205mm. Nothing has changed with how the subcompact SUV looks, other than the new dual-tone colour option, which has a black roof and pillars. There is also the EZ-Shift badge on the bootlid to differentiate it from the manual variant.

Engine
1.0-litre 3-cyl NA
Power
72bhp@6,250rpm
Price
Rs 6.5-8.9 lakh
(ex-showroom)

The cabin continues with the same layout and is quite spacious. The large 8-inch infotainment display allows for wireless Android Auto and Apple CarPlay connectivity, while the 7-inch instrument display with its youthful graphics and customisable displays offers minimal lag and good visibility.

The 1-litre three-cylinder engine produces 72bhp, which is paired with a 5-speed AMT. The setup is nice for most people who require a vehicle to commute to and fro their workplace and encounter a bit of traffic on the way, with the automatic gearbox letting one's left leg escape the clutchwork. Being a simple AMT, the gearbox works fine in low-speed conditions, especially in traffic and during mild acceleration. However, one has to plan the overtakes, as the transmission takes time to downshift, while at upshift, the power cuts off for a few seconds before a higher gear is engaged. The engine has its characteristic vibrations that do filter into the cabin quite especially when pushed hard, which is further compounded by the delay in upshifting by the AMT.

With prices starting at Rs 6.5 lakh and going up to Rs 8.9 lakh (ex-showroom) for the variant we drove, the Magnite EZ-Shift expands on the SUV's capable base, adding the convenience of an AMT while not compromising on comfort and tech. ■